

Minutes of the 1st CRF Operations Committee Meeting

The 1st meeting of the CRF Operations Committee was held in the Committee Room of the Department of Textile and Fibre Technology, IIT Delhi at 11:30 AM on the 22nd of September 2025.

It was attended by the following members:

Prof. Manidipa Banerjee (Chairperson, Head CRF)

Prof. Bhanu Nandan (Associate Head CRF)

Prof. S Nagendran, Department of Chemistry

Prof Pankaj Srivastava, Department of Physics

Prof Amit Gupta, Department of Mechanical Engineering

Prof Manjesh Kumar, Department of Chemical Engineering

Prof Jatin Panwar, Department of Biochemical Engineering and Biotechnology

Prof Jayant Jain from the Department of Material Science and Engineering could not attend because of prior commitments.

The special invitees (PhD student representatives), Hitesh (2023CYZ8246), Dept. of Chemistry and Indranil Manna (2022MEZ8336), were invited for discussion on agenda 1 and 8(b).

The following agenda items were discussed:

Item 1. Process for operation and evaluation of individual CRF facilities: All members agreed on the requirement for yearly evaluation of individual facilities under CRF. The evaluation policies for CRF owned, adopted and shared facilities were discussed. The committee suggested the following:

- All CRF owned, adopted and shared facilities to undergo yearly evaluation on the basis of usage statistics, user satisfaction, revenue generation, life of equipment, downtime, consumable and repair costs, and scientific relevance and advancement at the national level.
- Equipment being donated by faculty/academic units of IIT Delhi be initially introduced into CRF in the shared mode. An exception may be made in the case of highly booked equipment like electron microscopes etc., which may be introduced immediately in the adopted mode.
- The status of equipment in shared mode be evaluated at the end of 1 year. If the equipment is highly utilized by internal/external entities, the status may be converted to adopted mode.
- If adopted/shared equipment/facilities are not optimally utilized, they may be returned to the parent departments upon evaluation and recommendation of the Operations Committee.

In this instance, feedback was requested from the special invitees. They suggested that in order to obtain detailed feedback on facilities, a separate channel be included in the CRF website. The special invitees requested the



Committee for speedy resolution of breakdowns for highly utilized equipment, which results in significant increase in PhD time.

Item 2. Increasing engagement of faculty coordinators: The Committee strongly recommended to increase the engagement of faculty coordinators of individual facilities for seamless operations and maximum output and suggested that faculty able to invest time in operations may be appointed as coordinators.

Item 3. Process for evaluation of CRF staff: As in item 1, the Operations Committee recommended that the performance of all CRF staff be evaluated every year. A draft evaluation form shared by the Head CRF is attached as Annexure-1. The committee recommended that decisions regarding promotion to next level, longer contract durations and other benefits may be based on performance evaluation. The committee also recommended that all staff be allocated to a minimum of 2 equipment to optimize manpower and prevent operational glitches in case of attrition.

The committee also stated that since CRF is essential for the research aims of the institute, a few permanent positions may be considered by the institute to maintain consistency in services and to prevent attrition of highly trained staff; and requested Head/Associate Head CRF to re-initiate discussions with the institute in this regard.

Item 4. Staff salary mapping issues and increase in HRA to 30%: The committee recommended to implement alterations as per IRD rules for project staff. The Head CRF informed the committee that there has been some uneven-ness in the mapping of salary scales for CRF staff by IRD in 2023-24. The committee suggested that the issues may be discussed with Dean RND.

Item 5. Immediate infrastructural needs: The Head CRF discussed immediate infrastructural needs such as maintenance of ACs purchased by CRF in the Hauz Khas campus, replacement of glass doors in the Ex-hall laboratories, malfunctioning of central AC in the Ex-hall laboratories, creation of double door in the NMR facility, and potential contamination of water in the Sonipat campus CRF and residential buildings. The Committee agreed that the issues are of immediate concern and requested the Head/Associate Head CRF to communicate the requirements to the infrastructure team for fast resolution.

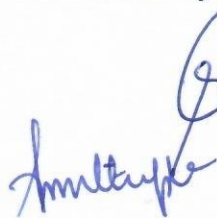
Item 6. Requests for inclusion of equipment in CRF: As per rules stated in Item 1.

Item 7. Opening of slots for specific equipment/facilities: The Head CRF informed the committee that the booking slots for a few owned/shared equipment need to be opened. The committee concurred, and also suggested that for all owned equipment, a CRF staff may be allocated for operations. For student volunteers engaged in doing samples for other users on adopted equipment, a payment limit of Rs 500 for a 4 hour slot may be standardized.

Item 8. Any other item.

a) Submission of grants to external agencies through CRF. The Head CRF suggested that for AMC/CMC, manpower cost generation, CRF may need to apply to external funding agencies. Clustering of equipment under specific areas will allow the faculty coordinators in a cluster to approach funding agencies for support. While the committee agreed that clustering of equipment is convenient from the operational perspective, however, the matter of grant submission to external agencies through CRF require further discussion and a clear understanding of modalities.

b) Student support in Sonipat. The student representatives suggested that for better quality of life in the Sonipat campus during visits/stays for equipment usage, the canteen should be operational for longer periods and also, Ashoka University facilities may be made accessible to IITD students. They suggested that these steps may increase



student footfall in the CRF/SATHI facilities in Sonipat. The committee decided to forward these suggestions to the Head Sonipat campus.

The meeting ended with a vote of thanks to the Chair.



Prof. Manidipa Baerjee
Head CRF



Prof. Bhanu Nandan
Associate Head CRF



Prof. S Nagendran
Member

(Not attended the meeting)

Prof. Jayant Jain
Member



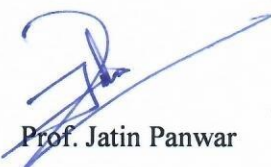
Prof. Pankaj Srivastava
Member



Prof. Amit Gupta
Member



Prof. Manjesh Kumar
Member



Prof. Jatin Panwar
Member

Annexure-1

INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY DELHI
PROFORMA-PERFORMANCE EVALUATION REPORT
CENTRAL RESEARCH FACILITIES

Period covered by this report from DD-MM-YYYY to DD-MM-YYYY

I. General Information

Employee Name:

Designation:

Email:

Primary Facility/Equipment:

Address/Phone no:

Secondary facility/Equipment:

Address/Phone no:

Facility coordinator Name/Phone/Email:

Present pay:

II. Technical Information

Metrics	Values	Self-appraisal by staff	Concurrence/comments from faculty coordinator
Number of samples done 1. Primary			

facility/equipment 2. Secondary facility/equipment			
Number of users 1. Primary facility/equipment 2. Secondary facility/equipment			
Revenue raised 1. Primary facility/equipment 2. Secondary facility/equipment			
Any publications from 1. Primary facility/equipment 2. Secondary facility/equipment			
User comment/satisfaction level			
Workshops/seminars conducted?			
Ability to resolve problems at own level			
Acceptance of additional responsibilities and receptive to change in work			
Contribution and improvement made in work areas			
Decision making ability			
Punctuality and Discipline (attendance from Timble)			
Record keeping and documentation ability			
Special talent and aptitude if any			
Any additional comment			
Recommendations for the next period			

Grading on 5 point scale corresponds to

A=5 [Excellent]; B=4 [Very Good]; C=3 [Good]; D=2 [Fair]; E=1 [Poor].